

Import Data Using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)

1. Brainstorming & Ideation Phase

- The Brainstorming and Ideation Phase is the initial stage of the project, where different ideas and possible approaches for importing spreadsheet data into a system are discussed. In this project, the main idea is to use a spreadsheet as the source of data and a Transform Map to transfer and transform that data into the required target table. Transform Maps are commonly used in platforms such as ServiceNow to control how imported data is mapped, transformed, validated, and inserted into a target table.

- The first step is to identify the problem that the project is intended to solve. In many organizations, information is maintained in Excel or CSV spreadsheets. Manually entering every record into a system can be time-consuming and may result in duplicate records, missing information, or typing errors. Therefore, the idea is to develop an automated or semi-automated process that can import spreadsheet data efficiently.

- During brainstorming, different data-import methods can be considered. These may include manual data entry, direct database insertion, import sets, integration tools, APIs, or spreadsheet-based importing through Transform Maps. The Transform Map approach is selected because it provides a structured method for matching source fields with destination fields and allows transformation logic to be applied before records are created or updated. Another important idea discussed during this phase is the type of data that will be imported. For example, a spreadsheet may contain employee information such as employee ID, employee name, department, email address, location, and joining date. The target system may have corresponding fields in an employee or user-related table. The project can demonstrate how these fields are connected through a Transform Map.

The brainstorming phase also considers possible challenges. The spreadsheet may contain incorrect values, empty fields, duplicate records, inconsistent date formats, or columns with different names from the target table. For example, the spreadsheet might use "Emp Name", while the target table uses "Employee Name". A proper mapping strategy is therefore necessary.

- The expected outcome of this phase is a clear project concept: prepare spreadsheet data, upload it into an import mechanism, create a Transform Map, map source fields to target fields, transform the data when required, validate the imported records, and document the complete process.

Thus, brainstorming establishes the overall direction of the project and helps determine how spreadsheet data can be transferred accurately and efficiently using Transform Maps.